

did it



Electoral college votes



Congressional Results Senate

Candidates	Votes			Electoral college
Obama	63,870,994	██████████	52.3%	349
McCain	56,378,757	██████████	46.4%	162
Others	1,525,254	██████████	1.1%	0

America is desperately looking for instant relief and long term remedy—or, the vision thing from the next leader of the free world. Abroad, it is involved in two expensive wars: the one in Afghanistan is turning out to be longer than the Second World War; and in the Mesopotamian swampland, it has already lost more than 3,000 lives. America has been bleeding from self-inflicted wounds. It was struggling to break free from the extremism of the neo-Conservative project. It was ready for a referendum on George Bush, who would in all probability leave the Oval Office with the lowest popular rating. America wanted a healer. And there he was, the calm preacher of hope and change. And in his high wattage

charisma, an idealistic generation saw the arrival of a Black JFK. Today, the Obamisation of America marks formal retreat of the conservative era that began with the Reagan revolution. It is the passage of another generational cycle of politics in America.

You can't miss the echo of Franklin Delano Roosevelt 1932 in Barack Obama 2008. FDR's New Deal needs a 21st century update and Obama, whose election is indebted to the economic meltdown, is ready to be the man, even at the risk of being labelled a 'socialist', which is worse than being called a terrorist in conservative America. (Maybe not after the

fall of Lehman Brothers and other towers of capitalism.)

Still, apart from the unsolicited endorsement from the economy, what else contributed to the phenomenon of Obama, which has become a sonorous synonym for the renewal of the American ideal? For, the velocity of his victory has swept away the last vestiges of Republicanism from the erstwhile citadels like Ohio, Florida and Pennsylvania. Other swing states like New Hampshire, Virginia, Iowa and New Mexico ensured the sweep. He got 96 per cent of the Black vote, 43 per cent of the White vote, 78 per cent of the youth vote; and the majority of almost every ethnic group, and even Jews voted for him. It happened because the